Lean Inception
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Lean Inception is the effective combination of Design Thinking and Lean StartUp to decide the MVP. It is a collaborative workshop divided into several stages and activities that will guide the team in building the right product.

About the MVP

The MVP, short for Minimum Viable Product, is the simplest version of the product to be made available to users to validate business hypotheses.

Facilitation techniques

The formation and group communication approach should vary according to the moment of the workshop and the style of each activity. In some situations, everyone needs to be involved in the same conversation, but in others, this is not effective. Here are some suggested techniques:

More at: https://www.caroli.org/en/tecnicas-facilitacion-lean-inception/

- Divide and Conquer
- Fishbowl Conversation
- Person in the spotlight
- Pomodoro
- Tell and Cluster
- Everyone talks and contributes
- You do it, I do it too, then we compare it
- Individual Brainstorm
- Voting

Credits

This template arises from the need to transform a very successful presential wokshop into a very effective remote workshop. Its elaboration is based on the practical experience and collaboration of many people who facilitates Lean Inception.

Organization, design, experience and writing:

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More info:

www.caroli.org

Lean Inception: How to Align People and Build the Right Product - Caroli.org

LEAD YOUR TEAM TO THE RIGHT WAY WITH THIS BEST SELLER BOOK! Learn how to execute a Lean Inception, the method capable of align people to build the ideal product! Release a new product isn't an easy task, since it takes a lot of risks. But what if you k...

www.amazon.com

Lean Inception: How to Align People and Build the Right Product 1, Caroli, Paulo, eBook - Amazon.com

Lean Inception: How to Align People and Build the Right Product - Kindle edition by Caroli, Paulo. Download it once and read it on your Kindle device, PC, phones or tablets. Use features like bookmarks, note taking and highlighting while reading Lean Inc...

www.udemy.com

The Step-by-Step Method for Successful Product Teams

Discover Lean Inception, the effective combination of Design Thinking and Lean StartUp

miro.com

Paulo Caroli's Lean Inception Workshop template | Miroverse

Discover how Paulo Caroli does Lean Inception in Miro with Miroverse, the Miro Community Templates Gallery. View Paulo's Miro templates.

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Kickoff

The Lean Inception starts with a kick-off, followed by a sequence of intense activities. and ends with a workshop showcase. The team directly involved with the initiative must participate in all activities; the other interested parties must participate in the kick-off and the showcase, where the expectations and results obtained in the workshop are presented, respectively.

Think big, start small, learn fast!

1. Ask the main sponsor of the initiative to open the Lean Inception with a speech about the initiative to be worked on.
2. Make a brief presentation about the Lean Inception agenda and the concept of MVP.
3. Ask everyone to write their names, using the color that identifies the level of participation.

Ethan Hamilton - Product Owner

Hernan Castro - Scrum Master

Isabel Montenegro - UI/UX Designer

Michael machado - Fullstack developer

Guilherme Abreu - Fullstack developer

Product Sponsor

Travel Content Creator Representative

Traveler Representative

Agenda

	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY
MORNING	KICKOFF PRODUCT VISION	PERSONAS	FEATURE BRAINSTORMING	SEQUENCER	SHOWCASE
	LUNCH				
AFTERNOON	IS - IS NOT - DOES - DOES NOT DO PRODUCT GOAL	USERS' JORNEYS	TECH, BUSINESS AND UX REVIEW	MVP CANVAS	SHOWCASE

Parking-lot

The Parking Lot helps to momentarily park conversations, ideas or questions that are raised during a conversation but are not useful for discussion at that specific time. It is an essential tool for the facilitator at any time during the workshop, as it is a polite way of saying: "yes, I heard you, but this conversation is for later".

Are we going to integrate with Meta login?

Are we going to integrate with Booking?

Are we going to integrate with Airbnb?

Are we going to set up a subscription plan?

Glossary

Take advantage of the Lean Inception to validate, adjust and give visibility to the vocabulary of the domain. It is very important that everyone involved - business, technology and user representatives - communicate and register the generated artifacts with a common language. Make sure to check the understanding of each word in the domain, and place it in the Glossary, visible to everyone.

- Social travel platform for discovering and sharing travel experiences.
- User who consumes travel content on the platform.
- User who publishes travel experiences and destinations.
- A travel experience shared by a user.
- A publication containing information, photos and videos about a trip.
- Main screen where travel posts are displayed to users.
- Positive interaction indicating interest in a travel post.
- Negative interaction indicating lack of interest in a travel post.
- Location associated with a travel experience.
- Trip or Skip — Positive/negative swipe answering "Would you take this trip?"
- Independent, low-cost travel style focused on flexibility and exploration.
- Trip — Public album of photos and videos from a user's travel. The content unit of the feed.
- Recommended period of the year to visit a destination.
- Reputation score calculated from user interactions with published trips.
- Public page containing information and travel posts from a user.
- Roadmap — Paid, step-by-step travel plan (costs, lodging, restaurants, events). Always linked to a Trip. Can be private.

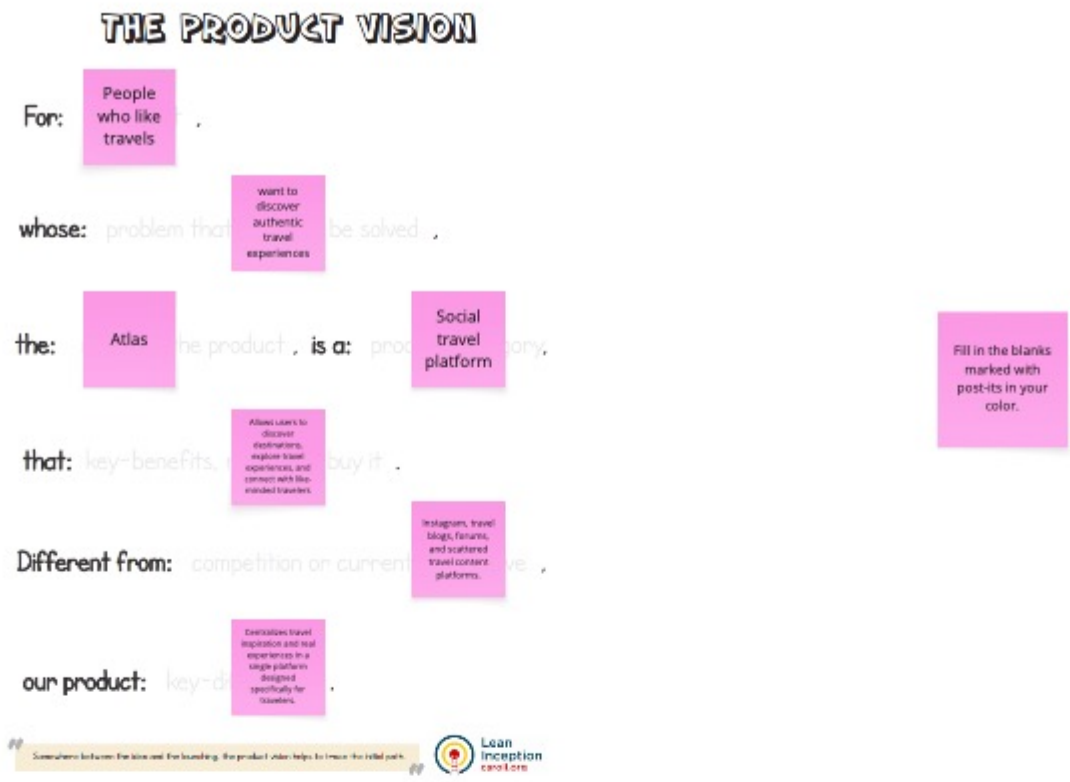
Product Vision

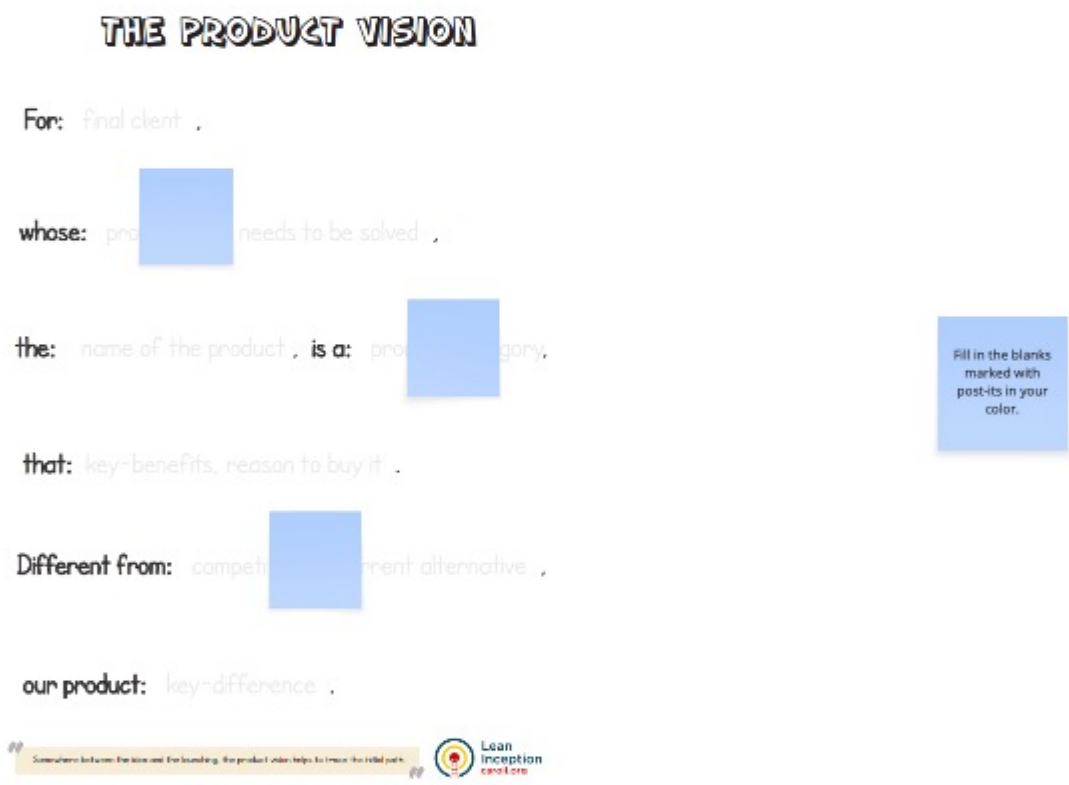
Somewhere between the idea and the launch of the MVP, the product vision helps you to walk the initial path. It defines the essence of your business value and should reflect a clear and compelling message to your customers. This activity will help you to define the product vision in a collaborative way.

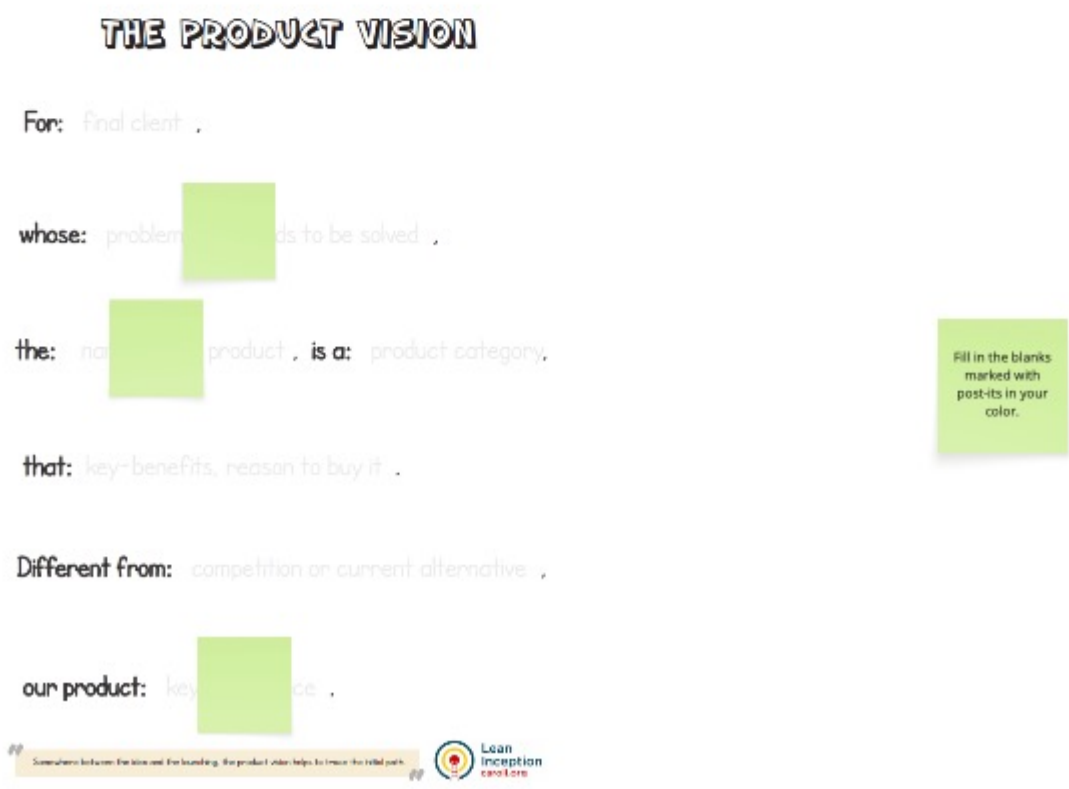
With a clear view of the product, you can determine how the initial "pieces" of the business will come together.

1. Divide the team into three groups and request that each group fill only the blanks selected in its respective template.
2. Ask each group to read their respective incomplete sentence and copy their post-its to the single template.
3. Ask the team to consolidate a homogeneous sentence, copying or rewriting the previous notes, as needed.

Activity 1: Product Vision







THE PRODUCT VISION

For: People who like travels ,

whose: want to discover authentic travel experiences ,

the: Atlas , is a: Social travel platform ,

that: Allows users to discover destinations, explore travel experiences, and connect with like-minded travelers .

Different from: Instagram, travel blogs, forums, and scattered travel content platforms. ,

our product: Centralizes travel inspiration and real experiences in a single platform designed specifically for travelers. .

Fill in the blanks marked with post-its in your color.

"Somewhere between the idea and the launching, the product vision helps to trace the initial path."

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THE PRODUCT VISION

For: final client ,

whose: pro needs to be solved ,

the: name of the product , **is a:** pro gory,

that: key-benefits, reason to buy it .

Different from: competi rrent alternative ,

our product: key-difference .

Fill in the blanks marked with post-its in your color.

"Somewhere between the idea and the launching, the product vision helps to trace the initial path."

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THE PRODUCT VISION

For: final client ,

whose: problem ds to be solved ,

the: na product , **is a:** product category,

that: key-benefits, reason to buy it .

Different from: competition or current alternative ,

our product: key ce .

"Somewhere between the idea and the launching, the product vision helps to trace the initial path."

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Fill in the blanks marked with post-its in your color.

The Product IS - IS NOT - DOES - DOES NOT DO

It is often easier to describe what something is not or does not do. This activity seeks classifications about the product following the four guidelines, specifically asking each positive and negative aspect about the product being or doing something.

Deciding what NOT to do is AS IMPORTANT as deciding what to do.

1. Divide the team into two groups and request that each group fill only the blanks selected in its respective template.
2. Ask a person to read a note. Talk about it. Group similar ones into a 'cluster' and place it on Canvas 1.
3. Go back to step 2, then ask the same for another person in the next group, until all notes are finished.

IS

- Mobile app
- Multi-platform
- App
- Free
- Facilitator for organizing pick up soccer matches

IS NOT

- FB, Twitter, whatsapp
- Site
- Chat
- messenger (chat)

DOES

- Schedule matches (agenda)
- Schedule fields
- List matches
- Locates nearby pick-up soccer matches
- Geolocation
- Alert on events
- Notify users
- Rating user
- Save reputation

DOES NOT

- Organize matches
- Define teams by request
- Organize matches and teams
- Asemble teams
- Manage payments
- Provide online payments of the match
- Organize championship

> "Sometimes, it's easier to describe something by telling what this thing is not or does not."

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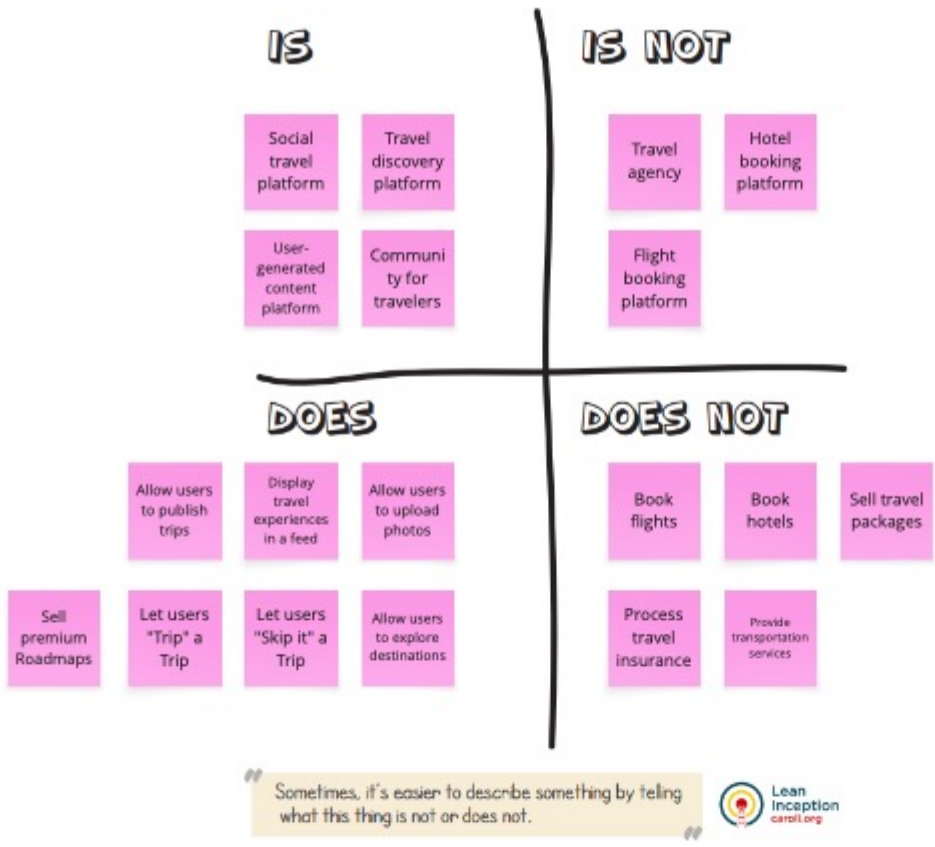
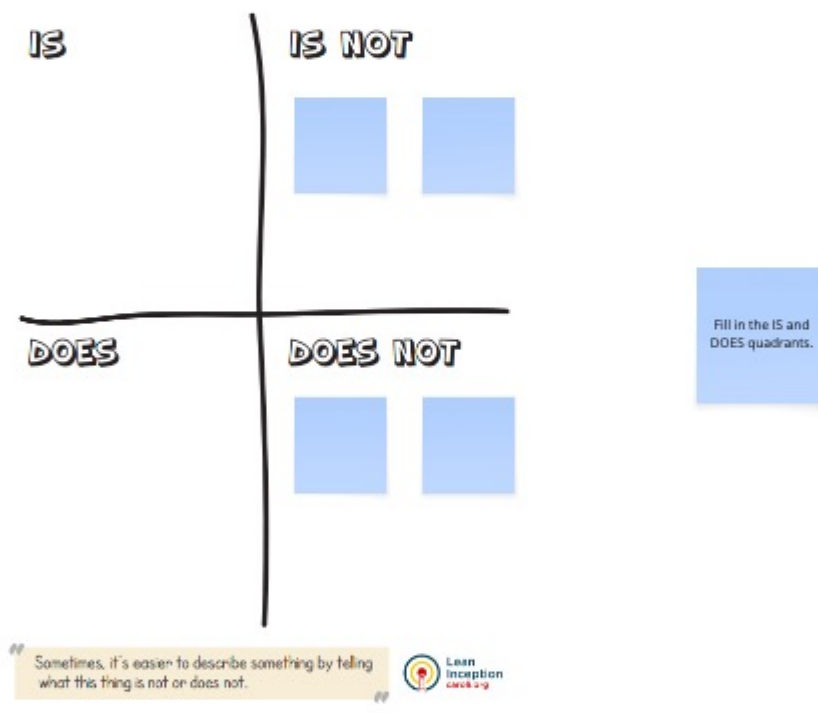
Activity 2: IS - IS NOT - DOES - DOES NOT DO





IS

- Social travel platform
- Travel discovery platform
- User-generated content platform
- Community for travelers

IS NOT

- Travel agency
- Hotel booking platform
- Flight booking platform

DOES

- Allow users to publish trips
- Display travel experiences in a feed
- Allow users to upload photos
- Sell premium Roadmaps
- Let users "Trip" a Trip
- Let users "Skip it" a Trip
- Allow users to explore destinations

DOES NOT

- Book flights
- Book hotels
- Sell travel packages
- Process travel insurance
- Provide transportation services

> Sometimes, it's easier to describe something by telling what this thing is not or does not.

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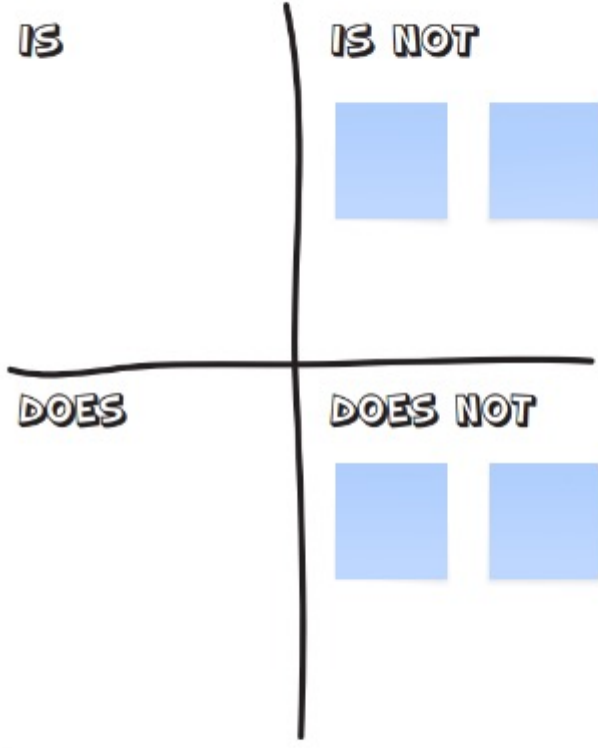

Fill in the IS and DOES quadrants.

"Sometimes, it's easier to describe something by telling what this thing is not or does not."

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Product Goals

Each participant must share what they understand as a business goal, and the various points of view must be discussed to reach a consensus on what is really important. This activity helps in raising and clarifying the main objectives.

If you have to summarize the product in three business goals, what would they be?

1. Divide the team into three groups and request that each group fill only the blanks selected in its respective template.
2. Ask participants to share what they have written, grouping them by similarity in the 'clusters'.
3. Define a title for each of the 'clusters'.

bring players together	publicize the app	monetize
find players	invite friends from work	sell ad space
show matches	advertise in the neighborhood	increase courts rental
find games by geolocation	reward loyal users	organize championship by player level
		make $ with advertising banner

Activity 3: Product Goals

Build a Travel Community

- Connect travelers
- Encourage travel sharing
- Create user engagement
- Promote authentic experiences

Enable Travel Discovery

- Provide authentic travel content
- Inspire future trips
- Simplify travel research
- Help users discover destinations

Build a Sustainable Business Model

- Enable travel guides marketplace
- Support creator economy
- Create premium travel content
- Generate platform revenue

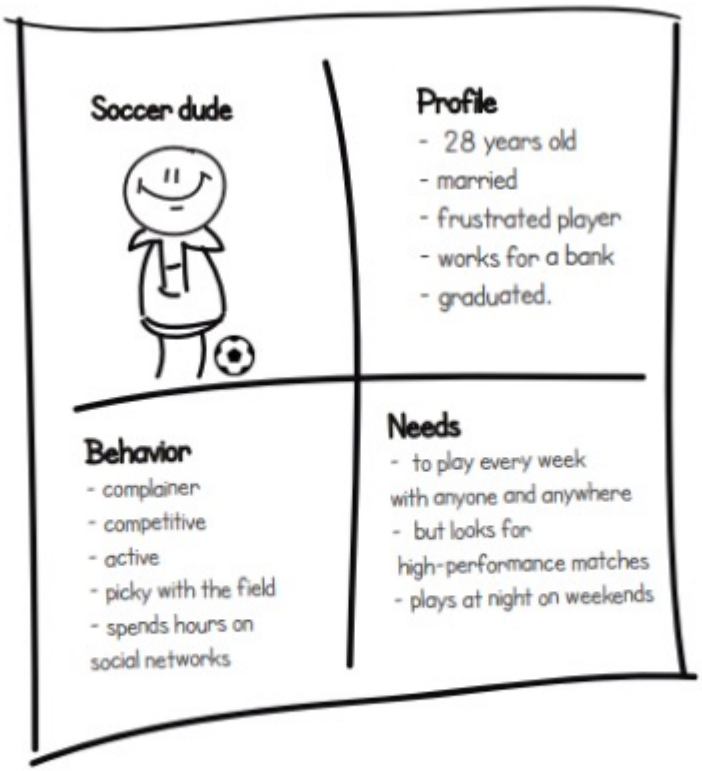
Personas

To effectively identify the features of a product, it is important to keep users and their goals in mind. A persona creates a realistic representation of users, helping the team to describe features from the point of view of those who will interact with the final product.

A persona represents a user of the product, describing not only his/her role, but also characteristics and needs.

1. Divide the team into three groups and ask each to describe ONE persona.
2. Each group presents its persona to the entire team.
3. Optionally, make more rounds to describe other personas. After each round, group them by similarity.

> To effectively identify the functionalities of a product it is important to have in mind users and their goals.



Activity 4: Personas

Annie Castle

26 years old

Marketing Manager

Lives in New York

Travels 2-3 times per year

Uses Instagram and TikTok for travel inspiration

Limited time to research destinations

Frequently browses travel content

Uses mobile apps daily

Follows travel influencers

Prefers authentic experiences over tourist attractions

Saves travel recommendations

Discover new destinations

Find trustworthy travel recommendation s

Get inspired for future vacations

Save time researching trips

Explore authentic experiences

Fill in the blanks marked with post-its in your color.

Miguel Guedes

35 years old

Travel creator

40k followers

Trav creat

Sell trip guides

Document every trip

Edit photos/video s

Monetizes content

Turn trips into income

Reach an engaged travel audience

Easy publishing tools

Fill in the blanks marked with post-its in your color.

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26 years old

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Turn trips into income

Reach an engaged travel audience

Easy publishing tools

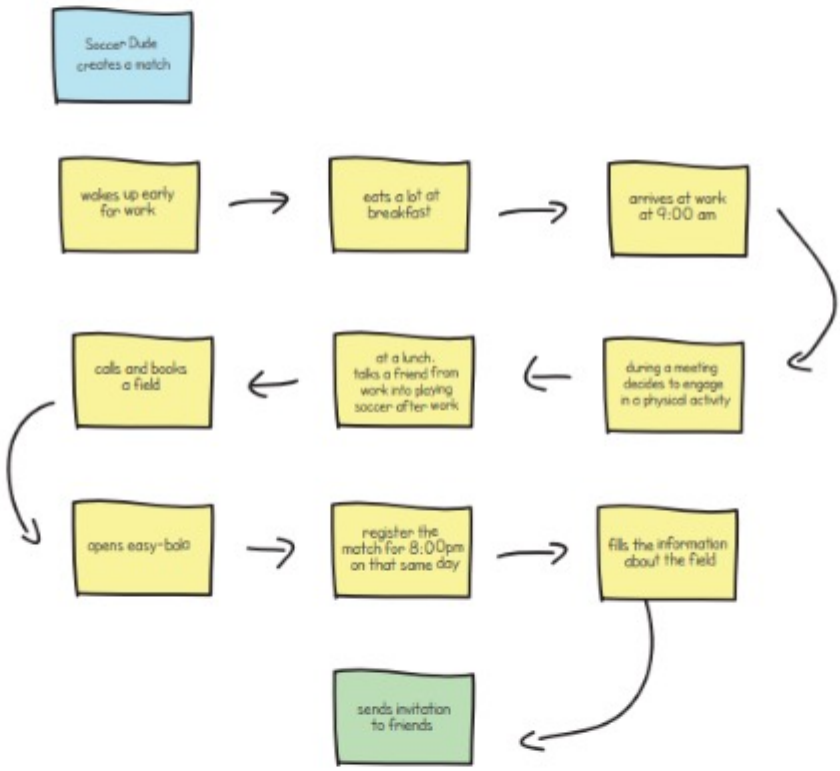
Fill in the blanks marked with post-its in your color.

User Journeys

The journey describes a user's journey through a sequence of steps to reach a goal. Some of these steps represent different points of contact with the product, characterizing the person's interaction with it.

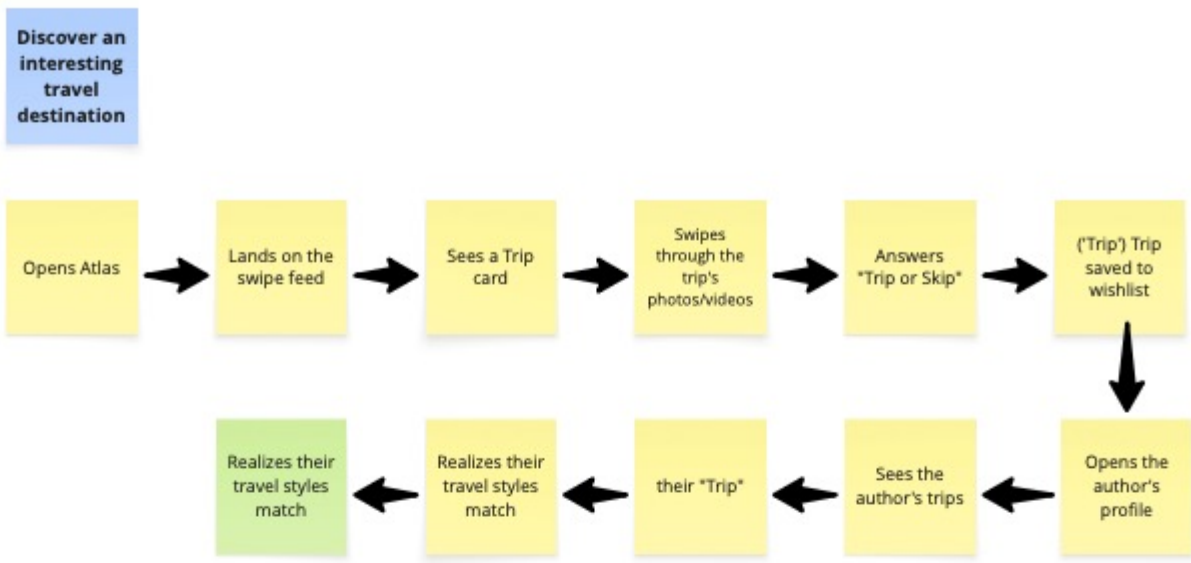
What goal does the persona want to achieve? Describe the journey step by step until the persona reaches it.

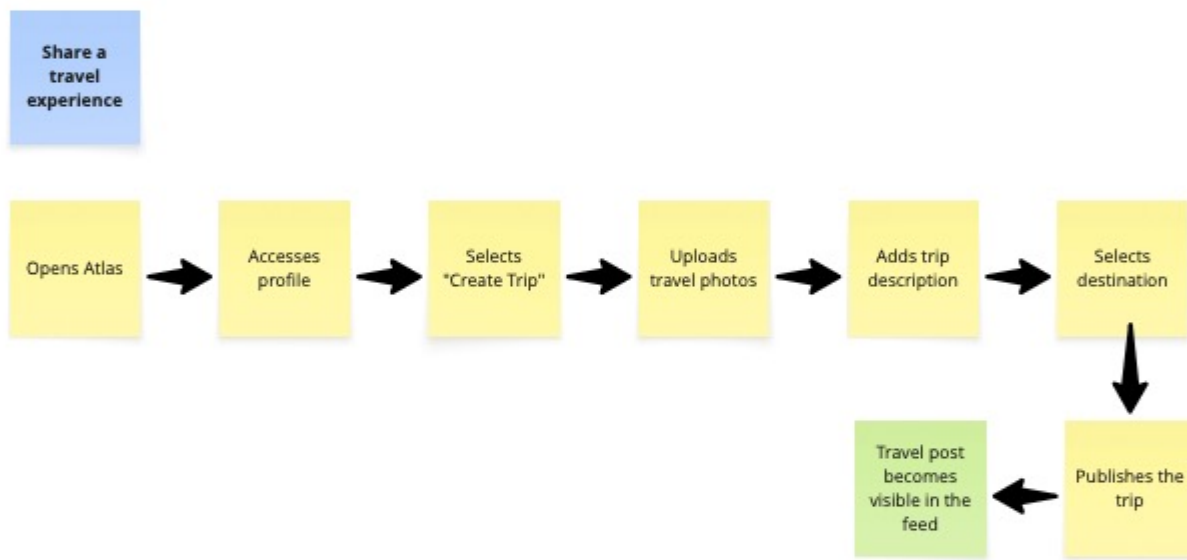
1. Divide the team into three groups and ask each to describe ONE journey.
2. Each group presents its journey to the entire team.
3. Optionally, make more rounds to describe other journeys.



> The User Journey describes a sequence of steps a user follows in order to reach a goal.

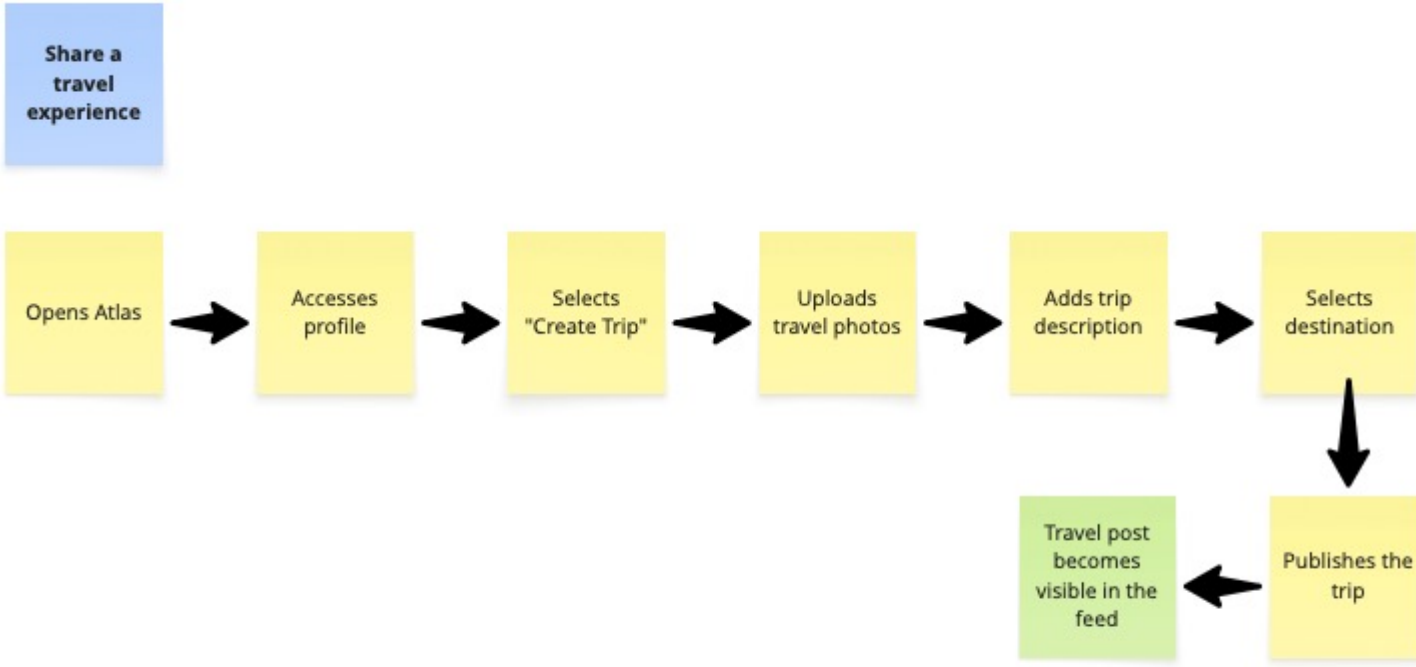
Activity 5: Users' Journeys





Discover an interesting travel destination

Opens Atlas → Lands on the swipe feed → Sees a Trip card → Swipes through the trip's photos/videos → Answers "Trip or Skip" → ('Trip') Trip saved to wishlist → Opens the author's profile → Sees the author's trips → their "Trip" → Realizes their travel styles match → Realizes their travel styles match


Share a travel experience
Opens Atlas
Accesses profile
Selects "Create Trip"
Uploads travel photos
Adds trip description
Selects destination
Publishes the trip
Travel post becomes visible in the feed

Sell a Roadmap

Opens a published Trip → Selects "Create Roadmap" → Adds costs, lodging, restaurants, events → Sets a price → Publishes → Roadmap available for purchase on that Trip

Feature Brainstorming

A feature represents a user's action or interaction with the product, for example: print invoice, view detailed statement and invite Facebook friends. The description of a feature must be as simple as possible, aiming to meet a business goal, a persona need, and / or contemplating a step in the journey.

The user is trying to do something, so the product must have a feature for that. What is this feature?

1. Ask someone to read, slowly, the step-by-step of a user's journey.
2. While reading, other people share feature ideas.
3. When a feature is identified, describe it and place it on the board. Repeat the previous steps for all journeys.

- Cancel participation
- Alert mode
- Player register
- Rank a player
- Alert of canceled match
- Detailed filter
- Financial details of the match
- Field ranking
- Alert of confirmed match
- Invite a friend to the match
- Players ranking (visualization)
- Find matches without geolocation
- Cancel match
- Confirm participation
- Match register
- Match details (place, time and day)
- Find matches with geolocation

Activity 6: Feature Brainstorming

- Create a profile
- Personalize a profile
- Create a travel story
- Upload photos
- Upload videos
- Categorize a trip
- Add songs on presentation
- Press the button "Trip"
- Press the button "Skip"
- Share with friends
- Find new places
- Learn about new places
- Organize your own guide
- Comment
- Save as favorites
- Send private messages
- Create a trip map view
- Create a Roadmap (linked to a Trip)
- Buy a Roadmap

Technical, Business and UX Review

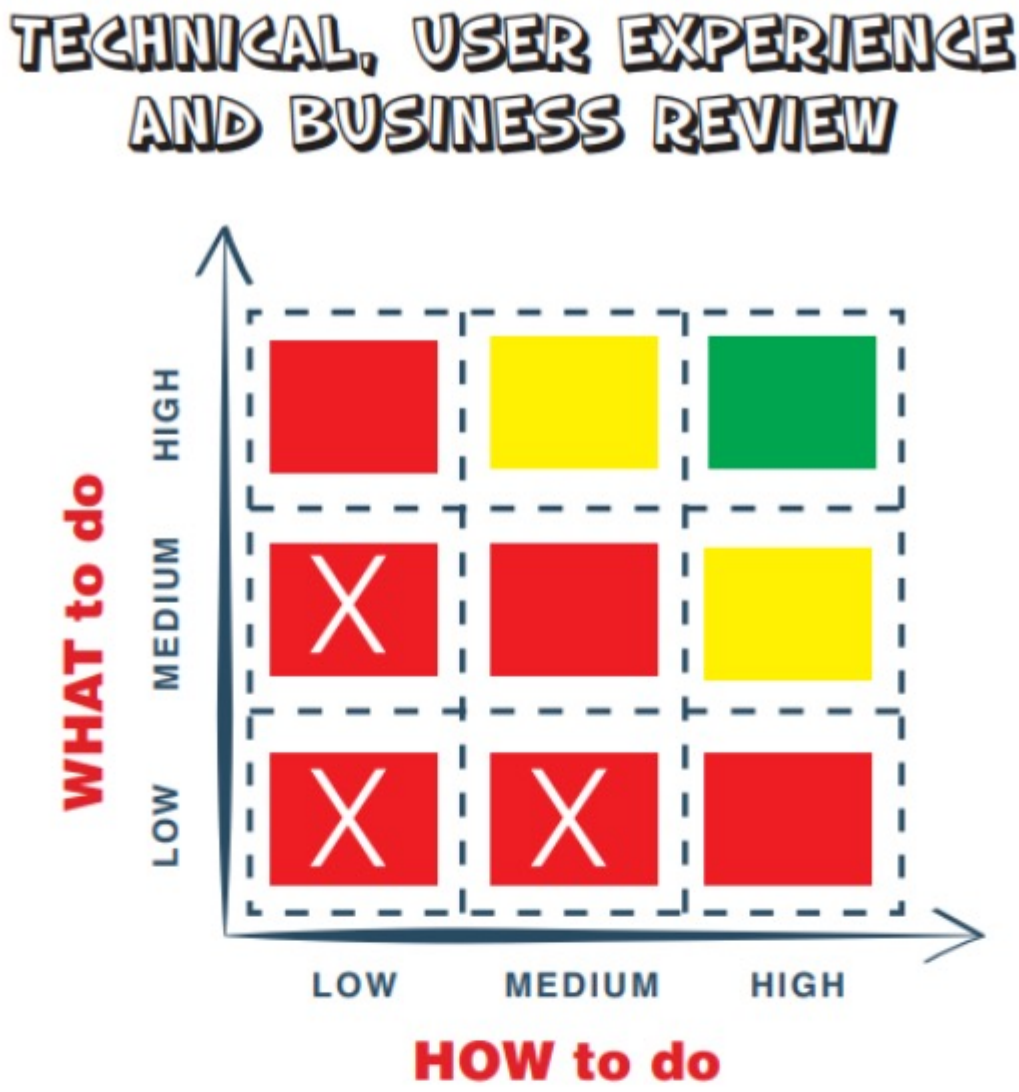
This review aims to discuss how the team feels about technical, business and UX understanding for each feature. From this activity, new clarifications will happen and the disagreements and doubts will become more apparent.

The colors and markings will assist the team in subsequent activities to prioritize, estimate and plan.

1. Ask a person to choose and drag a feature, going through the graph and table.
2. Define the color according to the confidence level and make markings (on a scale of 1 to 3) of business value, effort and UX value - $, E and ♥.
3. Confirm that everyone agrees; choose the next person and return to step 1.

EE $ <3<3<3 Cancel participation (red)	EE $$ <3<3 Financial details of the match (green)	EE $$ <3 Match register (green)	E $$ <3<3 Player register (green)	E $$$ <3<3<3 Cancel match (yellow)
E $$ <3<3<3 Match details (place, time and day) (green)	EEE $$ <3<3<3 Alert of canceled match (yellow)	E $$$ <3<3<3 Find matches without geolocation (yellow)	EE $ <3<3<3 Confirm participation (green)	EEE $$$ <3<3<3 Alert Dispatcher (red)
E $$$ <3<3<3 Alert of confirmed match (green)	E $$$ <3<3<3 Invite a friend to the match (yellow)	E $$ <3<3<3 Players ranking (visualization) (green)	E $$$ <3<3<3 Field ranking (green)	

Activity 7: Technical, Business and UX Review



EFFORT	E	EE	EEE
BUSINESS	$	$$	$$$
UX	♥	♥♥	♥♥♥

> The first step in organizing your work is relatively coloring and marking each item. Then you can start prioritizing your list, so that you decide what to focus on.

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Sequencer

The Feature Sequencer assists in organizing and viewing the features and the incremental validation of the product.

Define the MVP and its subsequent increments.

1. Ask people to decide the first feature
2. Bring more cards to the sequencer. Respect the rules.
3. Identify the MVP and the increments of the product.

RULES

Rule 1: A wave can contain a maximum of three cards.

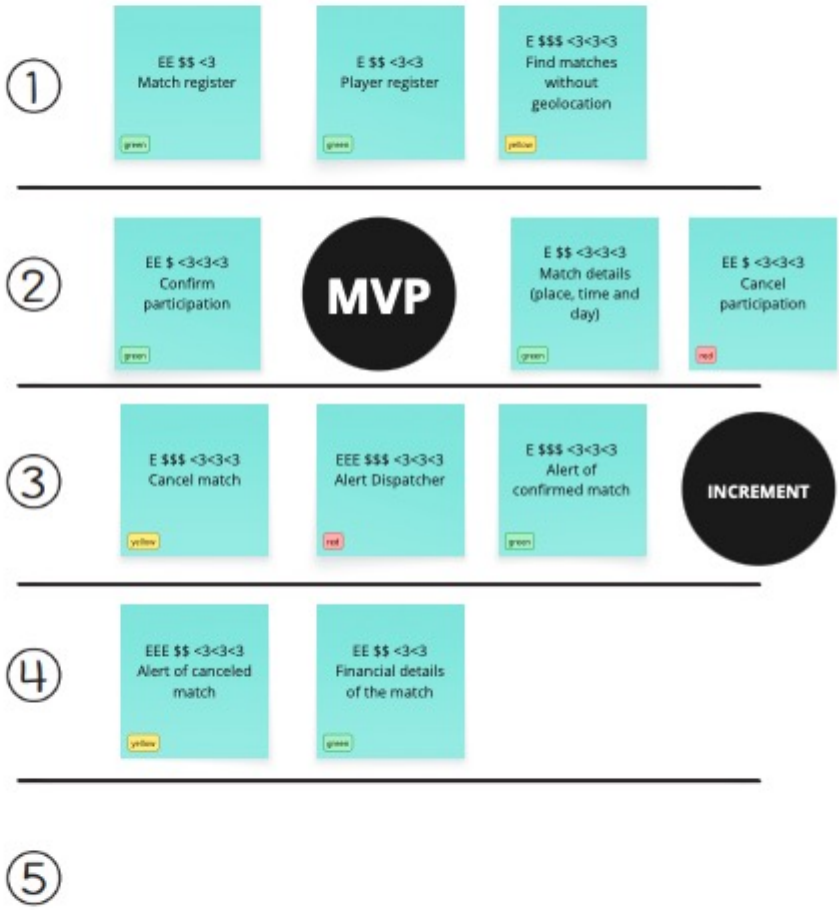
Rule 2: A wave cannot contain more than one red card.

Rule 3: A wave cannot contain three cards, only yellow or red.

Rule 4: The total effort of the cards cannot exceed five Es.

Rule 5: The sum of the value of the cards cannot be less than four $ s and four hearts.

Rule 6: If one card depends on another, that other card must be on some previous wave.



"Get ready, plan, work and conquer!"

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Activity 8: Sequencer

SEQUENCER

Fill in the blanks marked with post-its in your color.

1
- E $ <3 Register a new user (green)
- E $ <3 Log in (green)
- EEE $$$ <3<3<3 Create Trip (yellow)

2
- EE $$$ <3 Categorize a Trip (yellow)
- EEE $$$ <3<3<3 Browse swipe feed (yellow)

3
- EE $$ <3<3<3 Navigate media in card (green)
- EE $$$ <3<3<3 Trip / Skip (green)
- EE $ <3<3<3 Personalize profile (green)

4
- E $$ <3<3 Wishlist (save Trip) (green)
- EE $$ <3<3 View Profile (Trips + 'Trip' button) (green)
- EE $$ <3<3 Add & reorder media (green)
- MVP

5
- EEE $$$ <3<3<3 Recommendation Algorithm (red)
- E $ <3<3 Random Trip Selector (green)

6
- EEE $$$ <3<3 People Suggestions (style match) (red)
- EE $$ <3<3 Follow a user (green)

7
- EEE $$ <3<3 Optimized Video Upload (yellow)
- EE $$ <3<3 Share a trip (green)

8
- EE $$ <3<3 Comment a Trip (yellow)
- E $$ <3 Invite a friend (green)
- INCREMENT 1

9
- EEE $$$ <3<3 Create a Roadmap (yellow)

10
- EE $$$ <3<3 Buy a Roadmap (red)
- EE $$ <3 Private Roadmaps (yellow)

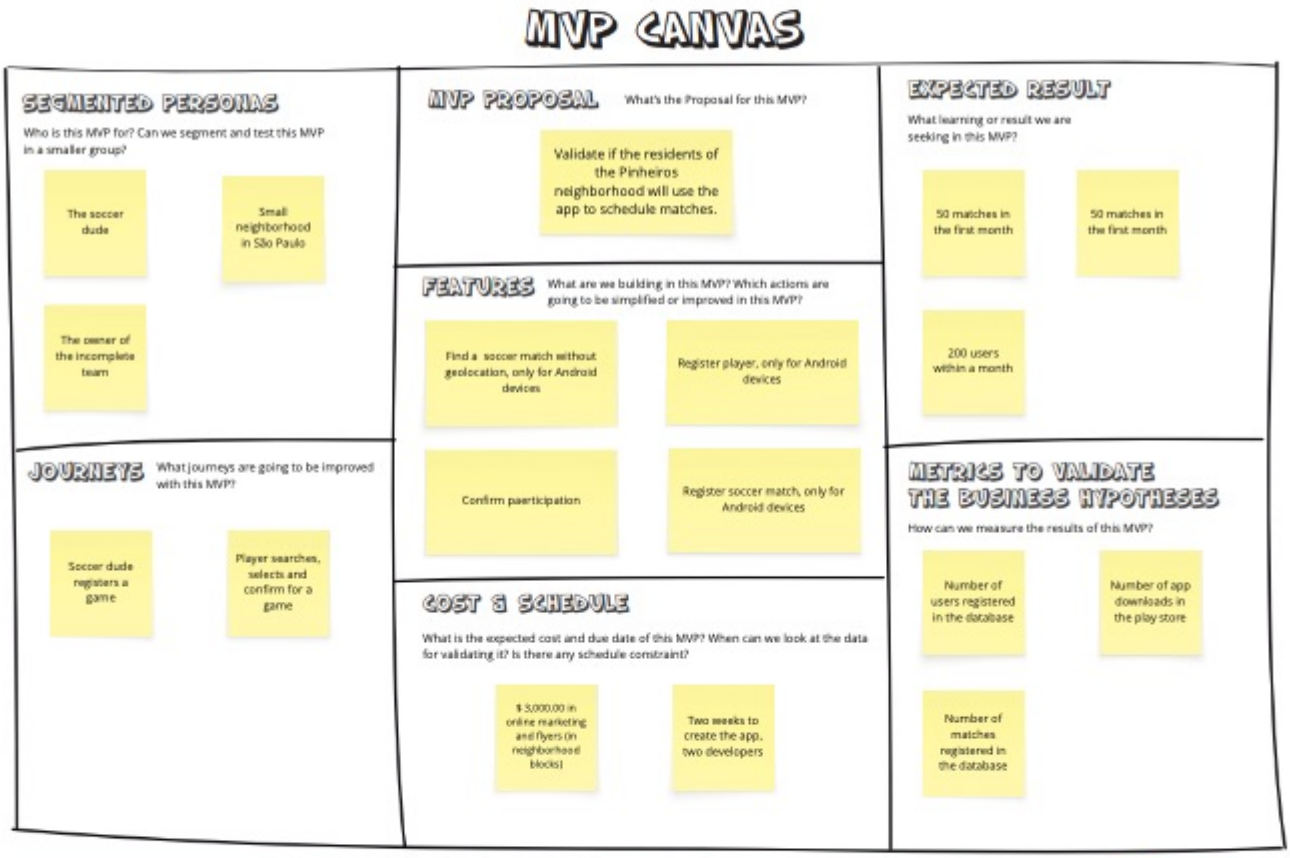
11
- EEE $$$ <3 Creator Payout (red)
- INCREMENT 2

MVP Canvas

The MVP Canvas is a visual chart that helps the team to align and define the MVP, the simplest version of the product that can be made available to the business (minimum product) and that can be effectively used and validated by the end user (viable product).

The team has already discussed what makes up the MVP and has already talked about what is expected of it, the time has come to summarize everything.

1. Divide the team into two groups and ask each group to complete the MVP canvas in their respective template.
2. Ask each group to present their Canvas MVP.
3. Ask the team to consolidate the seven blocks of the MVP canvas, using and changing the previous notes as needed.



> Do not waste time, money and effort creating the wrong product. Validate your idea and build your MVP!

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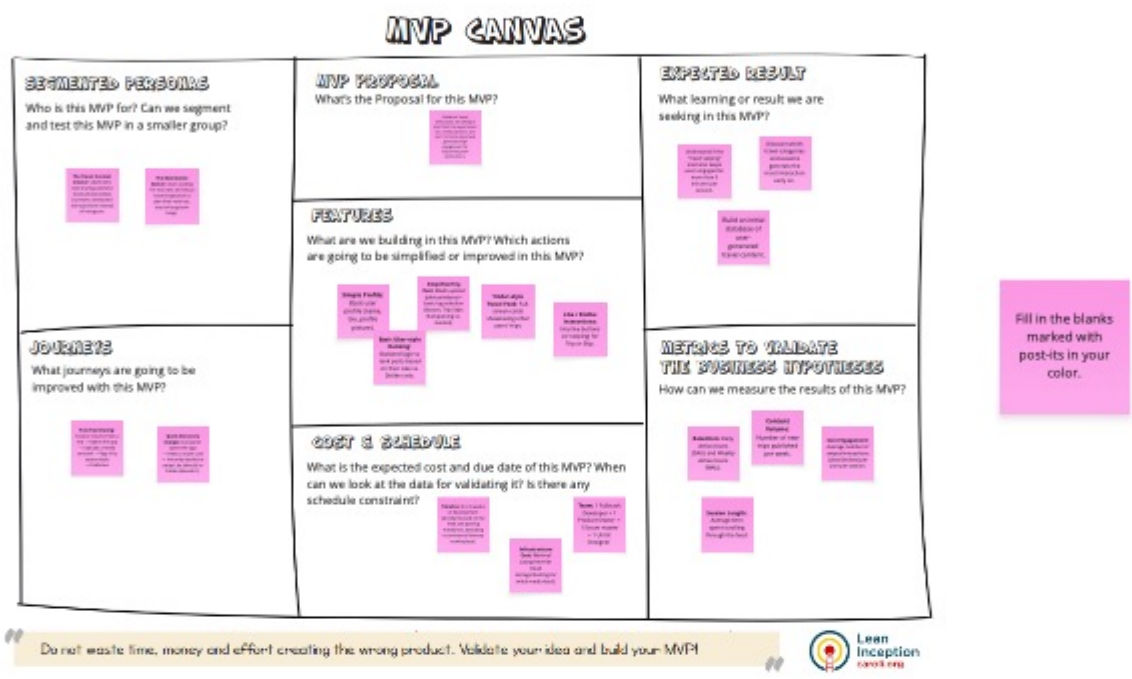
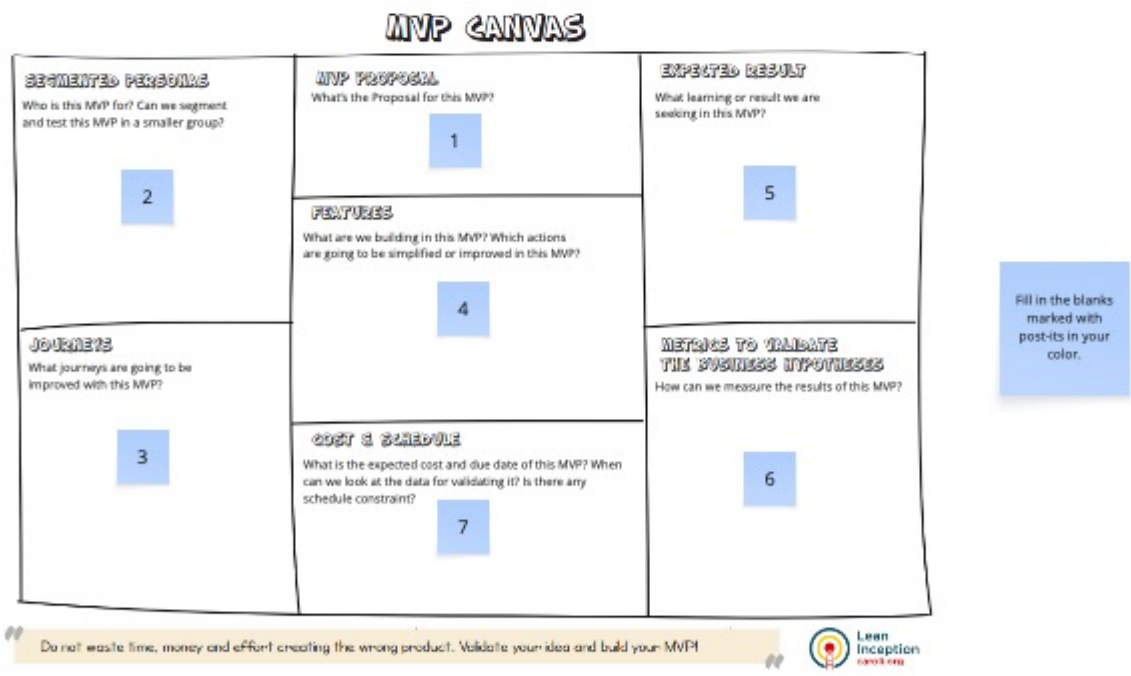
Activity 9: MVP Canvas



Fill in the blanks marked with post-its in your color.



Fill in the blanks marked with post-its in your color.

MVP CANVAS

SEGMENTED PERSONAS

Who is this MVP for? Can we segment and test this MVP in a smaller group?

MVP PROPOSAL

What's the Proposal for this MVP?

EXPECTED RESULT

What learning or result we are seeking in this MVP?

Build an initial database of user-generated travel content.

FEATURES

What are we building in this MVP? Which actions are going to be simplified or improved in this MVP?

Simple Profile: Basic user profile (name, bio, profile picture).

Simplified Trip Post: Mobile-optimized photo/video + text-only interface (Instagram, Twitter).

Basic User-style Ranking: Backend logic to rank posts based on their role in Trekki core.

Feeder-style Travel Feed: Full-screen cards showcasing other users' TV Qs.

Like / Dislike Interactions: Intuitive buttons for swiping (or Tapping) Trip or Skip.

JOURNEYS

What journeys are going to be improved with this MVP?

METRICS TO VALIDATE THE BUSINESS HYPOTHESES

How can we measure the results of this MVP?

Retention: Daily Active Users (DAU) and Weekly Active Users (WAU).

Content Volume: Number of new trips published per week.

Interaction/Engagement: Average number of related interactions (Like/Dislike/Share) per session.

Session Length: Average time spent scrolling through the feed.

COST & SCHEDULE

What is the expected cost and due date of this MVP? When can we look at the data for validating it? Is there any schedule constraint?

Timeline: Aim to complete all development activities (including QA) within the first month, excluding unpredictable external factors (e.g., App Store review delays).

Infrastructure Cost: Minimal costs, leveraging free tier cloud services (Firebase/Supabase) for initial development.

Team: 1 Full-Stack Developer + 1 Product Owner + 1 Part-time/Freelance UI/UX Designer.

Fill in the blanks marked with post-its in your color.

> Do not waste time, money and effort creating the wrong product. Validate your idea and build your MVP!

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MVP CANVAS

SEGMENTED PERSONAS

Who is this MVP for? Can we segment and test this MVP in a smaller group?

2

MVP PROPOSAL

What's the Proposal for this MVP?

1

EXPECTED RESULT

What learning or result we are seeking in this MVP?

5

FEATURES

What are we building in this MVP? Which actions are going to be simplified or improved in this MVP?

4

JOURNEYS

What journeys are going to be improved with this MVP?

3

METRICS TO VALIDATE THE BUSINESS HYPOTHESES

How can we measure the results of this MVP?

6

COST & SCHEDULE

What is the expected cost and due date of this MVP? When can we look at the data for validating it? Is there any schedule constraint?

7

Fill in the blanks marked with post-its in your color.

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SHOWCASE